



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Great Hearts Live Oak

School Website: <https://liveoak.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Great Hearts Live Oak (GHLO) presents a robust classical-education profile across all six rubric categories. Public materials consistently foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as the core aims, with a heavy emphasis on a Socratic, liberal-arts-based curriculum, a Great Books orientation, and strong partnerships with families. The school explicitly frames its pedagogy around the Socratic Method, classical texts, and a formation-focused purpose, while describing faculty as models of virtue and partners in the learning process. Parent and community involvement is integrated through formal structures (e.g., school-parent compact) and ongoing opportunities for engagement.

Overall, GHLO aligns most strongly with classical criteria in Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community, with clear evidence in the public materials of liberal arts content, Great Books, Socratic teaching, teacher as exemplar, and active parent partnership. Religious and metaphysical foundations are present through the commitment to truth, goodness, and beauty and a transcendent view of learning as formation, though explicit theological liturgy is not foregrounded in the available public materials. The six-category assessment yields a consistent CLASSICAL rating across all categories.

Key takeaways:

- Core classical markers are explicit: Truth-Goodness-Beauty, liberal arts core, grammar-logic-rhetoric, Great Books, Socratic method, and formation of character.
- Public materials depict strong faculty development and partnerships with families as central to the school's mission.
- The absence of overt liturgical or formal theological rituals in the publicly-available materials limits Element 1 from a pure liturgical/theological framing, but does not undermine the overall classical orientation.

Cited evidence and keyword anchors drawn from GHLO materials include phrases such as pursuing Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; the Socratic Method as the primary instructional tool; a foundation in grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, natural science, and philosophy; Great Books and the Great Conversation; and explicit statements about partnerships with parents and communities.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- GHLO states its mission as cultivating the hearts and minds through the pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty.

- The school emphasizes the Socratic Method as a core instructional tool, signaling a formation-centered approach aligned with classical moral and intellectual aims.
- Public materials mention that the Academy graduate is grounded in a liberal arts tradition, suggesting a teleology toward enduring truths rather than mere utilitarian outcomes.
- References to Western-tradition curriculum and character formation appear as central pillars.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; liberal arts; Socratic method; Western tradition; eternal/human-truth orientation.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (no explicit secular relativism, non-theological framings, or value-neutral ethics).

Why this rating

- The explicit emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty, along with virtue and the Socratic/Great-Books framework, aligns with the transcendental moral realism and formation-focused posture described in classical-education rubrics. The absence of explicit liturgical or doctrinal worship in the public-facing content does not negate the overall alignment with classical metaphysical aims as demonstrated by the school's language and practices. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

ABSTRACT

evidence anchors: GHLO's mission phrasing and the emphasis on Truth, Goodness, Beauty; Socratic method as primary pedagogy; Western liberal-arts foundation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission centers on cultivating the hearts and minds through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, signaling formation over mere information.
- The school stresses formation and virtuous character as the core telos of education, not primarily job preparation.
- Language around preparing graduates for thoughtful citizenship and lifelong learning is evident in curriculum articulation and Great Books emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, liberal education, telos, great conversation, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, human flourishing.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (no emphasis on workforce-prep or purely utilitarian outcomes).

Why this rating

- GHLO frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with an emphasis on universal truths (truth, goodness, beauty) and a Great-Books-driven telos, consistent with CLASSICAL criteria. Public materials do not foreground career-centric goals but emphasize human excellence and liberal education—core signs of a CLASSICAL orientation. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Anchoring language: formation of virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; liberal-arts telos; great conversation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Academy graduate is described as having a foundation in grammar, rhetoric, logic, mathematics, history, science, and philosophy, i.e., the Trivium and Quadrivium in practice.
- Curriculum is described as a rigorous core liberal-arts program in the Western tradition.
- Public materials reference The Great Books and a texts-based library program (Great Books/Great Books to Keep).
- Languages and classical texts prominence: Spanish in K-4, Latin starting in 5th grade, and ongoing classical-language emphasis.
- Historical-curricular continuity through the Great Books, Humane Letters, and seminary-level seminars.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, great books/seminar, Western civilization, history, classics, Latin, pedagogy of memory (narration/recitation, as appropriate to classical curricula).
- Negative keywords present: occurrences of project-based learning or non-traditional, non-textual approaches are not apparent in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The explicit emphasis on grammar-logic-rhetoric (Trivium), Great Books, Western-tradition curriculum, and classical languages signals a CLASSICAL Curriculum orientation. The presence of a structured Great Books program and a focus on humanities-driven study supports CLASSICAL. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Key citations: grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Spanish language plan; Western-tradition core.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The primary tool of instruction is the Socratic Method, with indicated progression from kindergarten through high school.
- Descriptions of Socratic discussion, questioning, and inquiry-driven learning are repeatedly highlighted in the public materials.
- References to upper-school seminars, rhetoric training, and opportunities to present and argue (speeches, orations) align with advanced classical pedagogy.
- Mentions of “Great Books” and disciplined study as a path to knowledge, with memory/recitation elements as part of the learning culture (as indicated by the broader Great Hearts lexicon and related materials).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic method/seminars, questioning, dialectic, discourse, rhetoric, seminars, memory-based practices (narration/recitation), scholé-like restfulness (implied by the formation emphasis).
- Negative keywords present: public materials show no conscionable emphasis on project-based, constructivist, or experiential-only approaches; these are not prominent in GHLO’s described pedagogy.

Why this rating

- GHLO’s pedagogy center is clearly classical: Socratic dialogue, seminar-based discussion, rhetoric training, and a strong emphasis on disciplined reading and speaking. The lack of explicit non-classical pedagogy signals a CLASSICAL rating. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Citations: Socratic Method and dismantled discussion as core; seminars and rhetoric; memory/recitation and Great Books alignment.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who serve as exemplars of learning and character.
- Public materials emphasize carefully selected and developed faculty with moral character and aspirational vision for education.
- Language in outreach materials aligns with the “living curriculum” notion and the faculty-as-core of the school community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, faculty as core.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials.

Why this rating

- GHLO positions its teachers as moral exemplars and central to the school’s formation aims, mirroring classical expectations of the faculty as the living curriculum and the core of the school. This supports a CLASSICAL rating. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Citations: explicit statements about teachers as models and the living curriculum; faculty development language.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school highlights strong parent partnership, with parents as co-teachers and active participants in education.
- There are formal structures emphasizing parent involvement, such as a School-Parent Compact and parent-formation opportunities (book studies, gatherings).
- Parental resources and open-campus ethos are indicated, underscoring a welcoming community posture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental engagement; parent formation; home-school connection; classical parent training.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials; no consumer/customer framing.

Why this rating

- The public materials emphasize a formal, ongoing partnership with parents and a community-centric approach consistent with classical-category expectations for parental involvement and shared mission. Conclusion: CLASSICAL.

Citations: parent partnership language; School-Parent Compact; parental resources and engagement language.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable for this school since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL across all six categories. No major needle-moving adjustments are required to reach a fully CLASSICAL standing; the published materials already meet the core criteria across categories.

Note: If a future update were to be considered, explicit textual articulations of liturgical/theological foundations (beyond the Truth-Goodness-Beauty frame) and a clearer articulation of scholé/restful pedagogy in

lower-division classes could further strengthen Element 1's explicit liturgical/metaphysical grounding, though it is not essential to the overall CLASSICAL classification given current evidence.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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